

TOPIC 1: CITIZENSHIP

1. Meaning of Citizenship

Citizenship is the legal status of being a member of a country. A citizen has rights protected by the state and duties towards the state and fellow citizens. Citizenship creates a bond of belonging and responsibility within the nation.

2. Ways of Acquiring Nigerian Citizenship

- **By birth** – A person born in Nigeria to Nigerian parents (or under conditions set by the Constitution) is a citizen by birth. Citizenship by birth is the strongest form and cannot easily be taken away.
- **By registration** – Certain people (e.g. a foreign woman married to a Nigerian man, or persons with specified connections) may apply to be registered as citizens if they meet legal conditions.
- **By naturalisation** – A foreigner who has lived in Nigeria for a required number of years, is of good character, and meets other constitutional conditions may apply to become a citizen by naturalisation.

3. Importance of Citizenship

Citizenship gives the right to vote and be voted for (subject to age and other rules), to live and work in the country, to hold a passport, and to enjoy the protection of the law. It also imposes duties such as loyalty, obedience to the law, and payment of taxes.

4. Summary

Citizenship is membership of a country. In Nigeria it is acquired by birth, registration or naturalisation. It carries both rights and responsibilities.

End of Topic 1